Banking in its loftiest shrine, adjoining appropriately the architectural height of St Paul's Cathedral, proved both pleasant and profitable from my point of view.'[8]

Deshmukh's work at the bank was monitored on a regular basis by Taylor who reported on his progress to Raisman. In one report he writes how he was pushing Deshmukh by handing over as much as he could to him and how he was shaping very well. In another report he notes that since all the work was new to Deshmukh, he still needed more experience but that his qualities of caution and commonsense would stand him in good stead. In June 1941, Taylor recorded Deshmukh's progress in a long telegram to Raisman certifying that Deshmukh was fit enough to be tried as Deputy Governor. This telegram was passed on to the India Office which cabled in September 1941, 'We are glad to know he has fulfilled expectations and agree to his appointment.'[9] Thus, as Deshmukh says, by the time the meeting of the Central Board was held at Madras in October 1941, everybody concerned had 'passed' him and the decision to appoint him in place of Sir Manilal was a mere formality. Since under the rules, it was necessary for him to be a non-official at the time of election, he resigned from the ICS a day before taking over his new charge.

Deshmukh observes that the idea of a European Deputy Governor was revived by the India Office towards the end of 1941 when he was appointed Deputy Governor but Taylor gave short shrift to the suggestion arguing that this was not in the best interest of either the selected European officer or of those Europeans who were already in the employ of the bank. He also expressed the view that a second Deputy was not really necessary as long as there was an Indian Deputy. The India Office were happy that Deshmukh's performance had passed muster with all concerned and now seemed to have urged the appointment of a European Deputy with a view not to bar Deshmukh's way to the Governorship, but to give professional support to Deshmukh should he be appointed Governor. They however did not press their point of view.[10]

TAYLOR'S DEMISE

In no other sphere of the bank's activities during the war years was there greater drama than in the appointment of a successor to Taylor who died